ANCIENT WISDOM

THE MINDSET FOR GROWTH

COMPANION WORKBOOK

10 Timeless Mindset Shifts, Backed by Psychology, History, and Research — Turned Into Daily Practice

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BEFORE YOU BEGIN

How to Use This Workbook

This workbook is the companion to the audiobook The Mindset for Growth. The audiobook gives you the ancient method behind each mindset shift, backed by the psychology and history that prove it still works. This workbook is where you actually do the work — because listening builds understanding, but writing builds change.

A FEW GROUND RULES

- Since this is a digital workbook, you can print it out. However, most people prefer simply using a journal alongside.
- Don't rush to fill-in prompts. The value is in writing your own words, not skimming someone else's.
- Revisit your weekly, monthly, and 90-day trackers even after you finish the book. Growth compounds through repetition, not a single pass.
- There are no wrong answers here. Be honest, not expressive — this workbook is for you, not for anyone else.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

- A pen, and about fifteen to twenty minutes per chapter.
- A quiet moment, ideally right after listening to each chapter while it's still fresh.
- The willingness to actually finish the sentences, not just read them.

> **A NOTE FROM TUBE AUDIOBOOKS**
>
> Thank you for choosing this audiobook and workbook. If you're following along, you're already doing something most people never do: turning ancient wisdom into a system you can actually use. Follow @Tube_Audiobooks_FY for more audiobooks like this one.

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CHAPTER 1 OF 8 · TUBE AUDIOBOOKS

1. Keep the Beginner's Mind

ANCIENT SOURCE: Socrates, Confucius, Lao Tzu, and the Zen tradition (shoshin)

WHY THIS CHAPTER MATTERS FOR YOUR GROWTH

Growth has a ceiling, and that ceiling is called certainty. The moment you decide you already know enough, you stop updating — and a mind that stops updating stops compounding. This chapter keeps your growth uncapped by keeping you teachable long after you've become competent.

> *"I neither know nor think that I know."*
> **— Socrates**

YOUR PRACTICE

EXERCISE 1 Three Socratic Questions

Choose one belief you hold strongly. Put it through Socrates' three questions.

My Belief	What Exactly Do I Mean By This?	What Evidence Do I Actually Have?	What Would Change My Mind?

EXERCISE 2 Fifteen Minutes as a Novice

Each day this week, spend fifteen minutes studying one skill as if you knew nothing about it. Log what confused you.

Day	Skill / Topic	What Confused Me

EXERCISE 3 Test One Assumption

Write down one assumption shaping your decisions this week, then design the smallest, cheapest test that could prove it wrong.

My assumption:

My small test:

Result — did it change my mind?

EXERCISE 4 Ask Before You Answer

In your next five conversations, ask one genuine follow-up question before sharing your own opinion. Check off each one.

- ☐ Conversation 1
- ☐ Conversation 2
- ☐ Conversation 3
- ☐ Conversation 4
- ☐ Conversation 5

REFLECTION

Where in your life have you mistaken familiarity for mastery?

CHAPTER 2 OF 8. · TUBE AUDIOBOOKS

2. Work for the Work, Not the Reward

ANCIENT SOURCE: The Bhagavad Gita — Karma Yoga, the Discipline of Action

WHY THIS CHAPTER MATTERS FOR YOUR GROWTH

Most growth dies not from lack of ability, but from quitting when results lag behind effort. This chapter protects your growth from that exact failure point by moving your motivation off the fruit, which you cannot control, and onto the work, which you can.

> *"Thy business is with action only, never with its fruits."*
> **— Krishna, the Bhagavad Gita**

YOUR PRACTICE

EXERCISE 1 Define Your Effort Standard

For each important task this week, write what excellent effort looks like — not what result you want.

Task	My Effort Standard	Met It? (Y/N)

EXERCISE 2 The Closing Ritual

When a work session ends, complete this ritual before you walk away.

What I completed today:

What comes next:

"The work is done; the fruit is not mine to hold." — Said aloud? ☐

EXERCISE 3 Effort Tracker

Mark each day you met your effort standard, regardless of outcome.

This week — Did I meet my effort standard?

Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

EXERCISE 4 Weekly Fruit Review

Once a week, ask these two questions separately — never blend them.

Did I follow my effort standard this week?

What did the results teach me?

REFLECTION

What result have you been clinging to that is distracting you from doing the work itself well?

CHAPTER 3 OF 8 · TUBE AUDIOBOOKS

3. Turn the Obstacle Into the Path

ANCIENT SOURCE: Marcus Aurelius, Meditations (c. 170 CE)

WHY THIS CHAPTER MATTERS FOR YOUR GROWTH

Growth is never a straight line, so any mindset for growth that can't handle obstacles is incomplete by design. This chapter keeps you moving forward when resistance shows up, and resistance always shows up, by converting every setback into raw material instead of a stop sign.

> *"What stands in the way becomes the way."*
> **— Marcus Aurelius**

YOUR PRACTICE

EXERCISE 1 The Three-Question Reframe

The next time something blocks you, work through these three questions in order.

The obstacle:

What part of this is in my control?

What is this obstacle giving me a chance to practice?

The smallest useful action I can take now:

EXERCISE 2 Sunday Setback Rehearsal

Each Sunday, name next week's most important goal and the two obstacles most likely to threaten it.

Goal	Likely Obstacle	My If-Then Plan

EXERCISE 3 Which Strength Does This Ask For?

Name a current difficulty, then circle the virtue it is training in you.

The difficulty:

- ☐ Wisdom
- ☐ Courage
- ☐ Justice

☐ Self-Control

EXERCISE 4 One Small Step Within the Hour

Log the small, concrete action you took today, within an hour of facing an obstacle.

This week — Did I take one small step within the hour?

Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

REFLECTION

Looking back, name one past obstacle that, in hindsight, made you stronger than you were before it.

CHAPTER 4 OF 8 · TUBE AUDIOBOOKS

4. Turn Habits into Identity.

ANCIENT SOURCE: Aristotle, Nicomachean Ethics (4th century BCE)

WHY THIS CHAPTER MATTERS FOR YOUR GROWTH

This is the machinery behind everything else in this book. Every mindset shift you've learned so far means nothing until it becomes a repeated action, because growth is never the product of a single decision — it's the compounding interest of small, consistent behavior.

> *"We become just by doing just acts, brave by doing brave acts."*
> **— Aristotle**

YOUR PRACTICE

EXERCISE 1 Choose Your Keystone Habit

Pick one repeated action that would make every other change easier.

My keystone habit:

Why this one will trigger other positive change:

EXERCISE 2 Habit Stacking Formula

Attach your new habit to an existing, automatic part of your day.

After I _____, I will _____.

EXERCISE 3 Shrink It Down

Rewrite your habit until it feels almost too easy to fail.

Original version:

Absurdly small version:

EXERCISE 4 30-Day Streak Tracker

Mark an X for every day you complete your habit. Remember the rule: miss one day without guilt, never miss two in a row.

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5	Day 6	Day 7	Day 8	Day 9	Day 10
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Day 11 ☐	Day 12 ☐	Day 13 ☐	Day 14 ☐	Day 15 ☐	Day 16 ☐	Day 17 ☐	Day 18 ☐	Day 19 ☐	Day 20 ☐
Day 21 ☐	Day 22 ☐	Day 23 ☐	Day 24 ☐	Day 25 ☐	Day 26 ☐	Day 27 ☐	Day 28 ☐	Day 29 ☐	Day 30 ☐

REFLECTION

A year from now, what would it mean for you if this one habit had simply never stopped?

CHAPTER 5 OF 8 · TUBE AUDIOBOOKS

5. Cultivate the Self, Choose Your Company

ANCIENT SOURCE: Confucius, The Analects (551–479 BCE)

WHY THIS CHAPTER MATTERS FOR YOUR GROWTH

The mindset for growth is not only an inward decision — it is an environmental one. You can master every mental shift in this book and still stall out if the people around you are quietly pulling you backward. Growth requires two projects at once: refining yourself, and refining the room you sit in while doing it.

> *"When I walk along with two others, from them I will select a teacher."*
> **— Confucius**

YOUR PRACTICE

EXERCISE 1 The Five-Person Audit

List the five people you spend the most time with. Be honest about their pull on you.

Name	Pulls Me Toward Growth / Away From It	Notes

EXERCISE 2 Turn Every Encounter Into a Lesson

After a meaningful interaction this week, log what that person taught you — as a model, or as a warning.

Person	Model or Warning?	What They Taught Me

EXERCISE 3 Monthly Self-Cultivation Goal

Choose one trait or skill to strengthen over the next thirty days.

This month's trait/skill:

Why this one, right now:

Review date:

EXERCISE 4 One Deliberate Relationship Move

Based on your five-person audit, choose one concrete action to take this month.

My move:

With whom:

By when:

REFLECTION

Who in your life models the version of you that you're trying to become — and how could you spend more time near them?

CHAPTER 6 OF 8 · TUBE AUDIOBOOKS

6. Know Yourself, Know the Terrain

ANCIENT SOURCE: Sun Tzu, The Art of War (c. 5th century BCE)

WHY THIS CHAPTER MATTERS FOR YOUR GROWTH

Effort alone, however well-intentioned, can be wasted if it isn't aimed with accurate self-knowledge and a clear read of your situation. This chapter is the strategy layer of the mindset for growth: know your terrain, know yourself, and aim your effort where it actually compounds.

> *"Know yourself and know your enemy."*
> **— Sun Tzu**

YOUR PRACTICE

EXERCISE 1 Strengths & Weaknesses Map

Be as brutally honest as Sun Tzu's discipline demands.

My Genuine Strengths	My Genuine Limitations

EXERCISE 2 Choose Your Battles

List every major goal competing for your time. Rank cost against payoff, and mark keep or cut.

Goal / Commitment	Effort Cost (Low–High)	Payoff (Low–High)	Keep or Cut?

EXERCISE 3 Run a Pre-Mortem

Before committing to a major decision, imagine it has already failed one year from now. List every plausible reason why.

The decision:

Reasons it failed:

EXERCISE 4 The One-Page Plan

Before any significant project, complete this page.

My goal:

My two or three biggest risks:

My first concrete action:

How I'll know I'm on track:

REFLECTION

What is one current battle you already know, deep down, you should walk away from?

CHAPTER 7 OF 8 · TUBE AUDIOBOOKS

7. Use Time as If It Were Numbered

ANCIENT SOURCE: Seneca, On the Shortness of Life, and the Memento Mori tradition

WHY THIS CHAPTER MATTERS FOR YOUR GROWTH

Everything in this book, ownership, curiosity, discipline, resilience, adaptability, habit, reflection, character, and strategy, means nothing without the one resource that makes any of it usable: time. The mindset for growth is not complete until it is paired with an honest reckoning of exactly how much time you have to grow in.

> *"Life is long if you know how to use it."*
> **— Seneca**

YOUR PRACTICE

EXERCISE 1 Life in Decades

Each box below represents one decade of an average lifespan. Mark an X in every decade you have already lived through.

0–9 yrs ☐	**10–19 yrs** ☐	**20–29 yrs** ☐
30–39 yrs ☐	**40–49 yrs** ☐	**50–59 yrs** ☐
60–69 yrs ☐	**70–79 yrs** ☐	**80–89 yrs** ☐

EXERCISE 2 Audit & Cut Three Time-Wasters

Track your time honestly for three days. Name the three activities that consumed real hours for almost no return.

Time-Waster	Roughly How Many Hours a Week	My Cut Plan

EXERCISE 3 What Matters Most

In one sentence, name the outcome you would most regret not pursuing if your remaining weeks were fewer than you assumed.

EXERCISE 4 My 90-Day Priority

Choose one goal from this entire book. Give it a real deadline, and check in weekly.

My 90-day priority (from this book):

Deadline date:

Weekly check-in — did I move this forward?

W1	W2	W3	W4	W5	W6	W7	W8	W9	W10	W11	W12	W13
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

REFLECTION

If you knew you had only one more year of growth left to give, what would you finally stop postponing?

CHAPTER 8 OF 8 · TUBE AUDIOBOOKS

8. Own What Is Yours

ANCIENT SOURCE: Epictetus, Stoic Philosophy (Discourses & Enchiridion, 1st century CE)

WHY THIS CHAPTER MATTERS FOR YOUR GROWTH

This is the foundation the whole book stands on. Growth is not a gift handed to you by better circumstances — it's what happens when every ounce of your energy stops leaking into things you can't change and pours instead into what you can. Master this shift, and you've built the soil that growth actually grows in.

> *"Some things are in our control, and others are not."*
> **— Epictetus**

YOUR PRACTICE

EXERCISE 1 The Three-Circle Sort

List every worry currently occupying your mind. Then sort each one into the column where it belongs.

Fully In My Control	I Can Influence	Not In My Control

EXERCISE 2 Rewrite One Complaint as an Action

Take your loudest complaint from the outer circles above and translate it into one sentence describing what you will actually do.

My Complaint	My Action Instead

EXERCISE 3 Name the Impression

The next time a disturbing thought shows up, write it down, then answer the one question that follows it.

The thought:

Is this within my control? What will I do about it:

EXERCISE 4 The Morning Declaration

Each morning, finish this sentence before you touch your phone: "Today, my part is…" List 1–3 items, then track the habit below.

Today, my part is:

7-Day Morning Declaration Tracker

Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

REFLECTION

What is one thing you have been trying to control this week that was never actually yours to control?

CLOSING

Your 10 Mindset Shifts, At a Glance

Keep this page bookmarked. When growth stalls, come back here and find the chapter that matches what you're facing right now.

#	Chapter	The Shift	Key Action
1	Keep the Beginner's Mind	From certainty, to staying teachable forever.	Ask one more question before you answer.
2	Work for the Work, Not the Reward	From chasing results, to committing fully to the work.	Track effort, not outcomes.
3	Turn the Obstacle Into the Path	From avoiding setbacks, to training through them.	Take one small step within the hour.
4	Turn Habits into identity	From motivation, to repeated, automatic action.	Shrink the habit until it can't fail.
5	Cultivate the Self, Choose Your Company	From changing others, to refining yourself and your circle.	Audit your five closest influences.
6	Know Yourself, Know the Terrain	From reactive effort, to prepared, strategic action.	Write the one-page plan before you act.
7	Use Time as If It Were Numbered	From "someday," to treating today like it's numbered.	Set your 90-day deadline today.
8	Own What Is Yours	From reacting to everything, to owning only what's yours.	Sort your worries into the three circles.

ONE LAST THING

A Note From Tube Audiobooks

8 mindset shifts, drawn from Stoic philosophy, Taoist teaching, the Bhagavad Gita, Confucian wisdom, and the strategic mind of Sun Tzu, all converge on the same simple truth: growth is built, not found. It is built through what you own, what you practice, what you repeat, and how honestly you examine the days you're given.

This workbook doesn't end when you close it. Come back to it. Rerun the exercises in three months and notice what's changed. That, more than anything else in this book, is what a mindset for growth actually looks like in practice.

KEEP GROWING WITH US

If this audiobook and workbook helped you, the best way to support more ancient-wisdom audiobooks like this one is to follow and share Tube Audiobooks.

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